

Pasta al Limone

Five ingredients. Ten minutes. One of the most satisfying pasta dishes in existence. The lemon must be unwaxed — everything depends on the zest.

Ingredients

- 400 g spaghetti or linguine
- 2 unwaxed lemons — zest of both, juice of one
- 80 g unsalted butter, cold and cubed
- 80 g Parmigiano Reggiano, finely grated
- Generous amount of freshly cracked black pepper
- Salt for pasta water

Method

1. Cook pasta in heavily salted boiling water until 1 minute before al dente. Reserve 2 cups of pasta water.
2. In a wide pan over medium-low heat, melt half the butter with the lemon zest. Toast gently for 30 seconds.
3. Add the lemon juice and 1 cup of pasta water. Bring to a gentle simmer.
4. Add the drained pasta and toss constantly, adding cold butter cubes one at a time.
5. Add Parmesan gradually, tossing and adding splashes of pasta water to maintain a silky sauce.
6. Remove from heat. Add a very generous amount of black pepper. Toss once more and serve immediately.